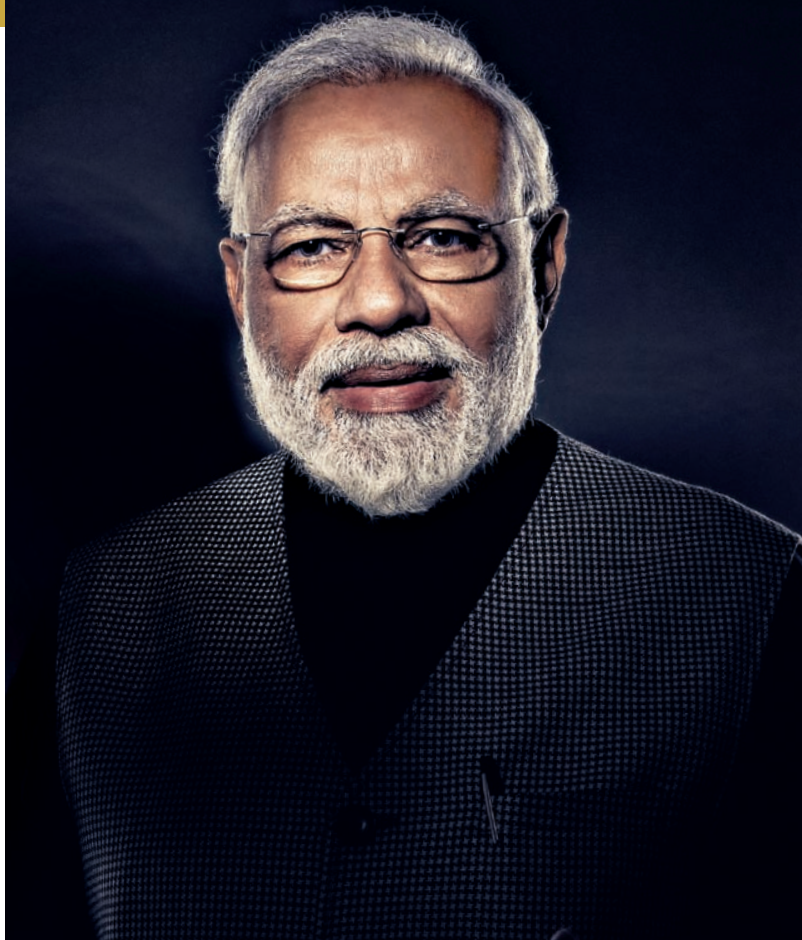




**“Over the last few years, India has received record FDI and created millions of jobs. It is in this journey that Invest India, the start-up of the Government of India, has played a crucial role in unleashing the country’s talent, creativity and zeal... The efforts towards increasing both ease of living and ease of doing business as also making our systems vibrant and resilient have paved the way for unlimited opportunities”**

**NARENDRA MODI, PRIME MINISTER OF INDIA**  
(EXCERPTS TAKEN FROM THE PM’S LETTER TO INVEST INDIA ON DECEMBER 19, 2020)

others. India is now being increasingly discussed in global boardrooms as a ‘China plus 1’ option.

**W**ITH 411 EMPLOYEES, most of whom are young women, Invest India addresses every minute detail of investment. Founded in 2009 as a 49:51 joint venture between the central government and industry association Ficci, not much happened for the first seven years. “There was a small room within Ficci with not enough space to have meetings with investors,” says a person in the know. In fact, when professional CEO Bagla landed in February 2015, he had to do team meetings in a coffee shop near Delhi’s Bengali Market.

Things started to change around that time, when state governments were brought in as equity partners. The team under Bagla, which finally got a home at Vigyan Bhawan in January 2017, started creating new concept notes, brought in new ways of creating research reports, showing foreigners where the opportunities are, etc. “The government always had problems recruiting young people to come for a short time and make an impact. Often, the best and brightest also want to work in other areas such as consulting, finance, tech, etc. At the same time, there are several young people who are committed to helping the country, but don’t want to make a lifetime of it,” says Adil Zainulbhai, head of the Capacity Building Commission, which is mandated with transforming the Indian civil services learning ecosystem.

Bagla says the private-sector character of Invest India helps the government understand the investor’s perspective. “When